

RICHARD BLAIR

QA Engineer

(512) 423-4227 | rickyblair811@hotmail.com | 102 W Kamoi Ct, Bastrop, TX, 78602 | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/rrblair/>

CAREER SUMMARY

Senior QA and validation engineer with 20+ years of experience validating enterprise hardware, BIOS, firmware, and system software across AMD EPYC, Dell PowerEdge, and cloud platforms in a Datacenter environment. Proven expertise in post-silicon validation, power and performance testing, memory and HSIO subsystems, and automation-driven test strategies. Recognized for cross-functional leadership, mentoring global teams, and driving quality, reliability, and release readiness in complex enterprise environments.

EXPERTISE

AMD EPYC CPUs and platforms | Dell PowerEdge server platforms | BIOS, firmware, and BMC validation | DIMMs, memory subsystems, and RAS | Power and performance validation | HSIO interfaces (PCIe, SATA, USB, etc.) | Firmware and platform bring-up | Log-based analysis (BIOS, BMC, OS, sensor data) | Project management | Test automation frameworks and CI tools (Jenkins, APEX, Scrutinizer) | Reporting and dashboards (Excel, Power BI, Confluence), Datacenter bring up

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Post-silicon validation | Linux & Windows system validation | MemTest86 | AMD System Stress Tool | GSA | test strategy | Test plan and test case authoring | regression testing | ISO 9001 quality systems | Basic Python | Raritan PDU usage and power monitoring | Regression, functional, performance, and UAT testing | Jira | Confluence | Scrutinizer | APEX | ESX, VMware, Hypervisor | Guiding Project Retrospectives | Generative AI for Text Analysis

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MTS TEST ENGINEER | AMD | Austin, TX

Jan 2020 – Jan 2025

Validated AMD EPYC server platforms in a Datacenter environment with a focus on BIOS, firmware, memory, power, and performance across Windows and Linux environments. Led targeted validation of CPU, DIMMs, BMC, and platform features including PCIe, ACPI, UEFI, SMBIOS, IPMI, SATA, USB, and DDR. Executed post-silicon power, performance, and stress testing using industry and AMD internal tools, analyzed BIOS/BMC/OS logs to debug system-level issues, and supported production readiness across multiple EPYC generations. Developed test plans and test cases, supported automation and CI workflows, collaborated with global validation teams, and reported quality and status metrics to engineering leadership. Configured Microsoft HLK environment and supported testing. Performed team retrospectives at the end of each project. Was laid off in January 2025

CONTRACTOR – HARDWARE VALIDATION ENGINEER | Dell. | Austin, TX

Dec 2018 – Jun 2019

Developed and executed hardware and BIOS validation strategies for Dell PowerEdge server platforms in a Datacenter environment, including creation of comprehensive test plans, test cases, and automation tools. Led and coordinated test execution across internal teams and external validation partners, managed test deliverables, and reported validation results to engineering leadership. Drove process improvements and automation adoption to increase test coverage and reduce execution time, mentored engineers and technicians, and supported release readiness and quality sign-off for new and existing hardware solutions. Contract ended after eight months in June 2018.

CONTRACTOR – DEBUG TECHNICIAN | FLEX | Austin, TX

Oct 2018 – Dec 2018

Performed hands-on debugging and repair of complex mechanical and electrical assemblies within a manufacturing, Datacenter environment. Diagnosed issues to the component and PCBA level using electronic test equipment, including oscilloscopes, and collaborated with engineering teams to resolve functionality issues and improve procedures. Supported process equipment installation, debug, and validation, developed troubleshooting guides and work instructions, trained technicians, and helped monitor manufacturing yields, equipment performance, and safety compliance.

CONTRACTOR – SR QA ENGINEER | Dell | Austin, TX

Apr 2017 – Jan 2018

Executed functional, regression, and user acceptance testing for Dell's Custom Factory Integration (CFI), VMware AirWatch, and Factory as a Service (FaaS) offerings. Authored and executed test plans and test cases, reproduced and triaged defects, and collaborated with cross-functional teams through daily defect reviews. Collected and analyzed customer quality data to support UAT and ensure reliable factory image customization and delivery. Contract ended after 6 months in January 2018

CONTRACTOR – SR QA ENGINEER | AT&T Wi-Fi | Austin, TX

Aug 2016 – Aug 2017

Led QA and validation efforts for AT&T secure Wi-Fi and mobile device platforms, testing interfaces and applications across iOS and Android devices. Developed and maintained test plans for feature and regression testing, coordinated on-site vendor testing, and communicated issues clearly to internal and external partners. Configured and used network and UI automation tool, Spirent Landslide, to support end-to-end testing, provided release approval, audited test teams, and delivered clear quality status to management. Executed Eggplant IOS and Android automation.

CONTRACTOR – UAC QA ENGINEER | Dell | Austin, TX

Jun 2015 – Jun 2016

Managed and coordinated system, regression, functional, and user acceptance testing across internal, vendor, and offshore QA teams to ensure quality delivery of Dell computing platforms and software solutions. Developed comprehensive test plans and user acceptance scenarios, reproduced and analyzed defects, and provided regular quality status to management. Supported factory-installed system validation, collaborated with vendors and ODMs, and created test environments—including Active Directory and VMware configurations—to support WHQL certification and driver validation.

QUALITY ASSURANCE OFFICER | Gemalto | Austin, TX

Aug 2013 – May 2015

Oversaw quality governance for multiple concurrent, revenue-generating projects across software and hardware programs, ensuring compliance with established quality systems and processes. Conducted project and stakeholder quality audits, identified and escalated nonconformities, and partnered with management to drive process improvements and corrective actions. Trained project teams on quality methods and tools, supported product deployment planning, and represented the quality organization in operational, review, and audit forums.. Taught a class for Intellectual Property for Texas sites.

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT MANAGER | RioTel | Austin, TX

Jun 2013 – Aug 2013

Supported the configuration and deployment of TraK, a SaaS project management application, by gathering customer requirements and defining user acceptance tests to enhance end-user experience. Acted as a liaison between customers and internal teams, translating business needs into functional requirements and validation criteria. Provided team leadership as needed, guided less-experienced staff through the software development lifecycle, and ensured successful implementation for enterprise and telecom clients.

SR QA ENGINEER/ CUSTOMER VALIDATION MANAGER | Computer Associates | Austin, TX

Jan 2009 – May 2013

Led customer-facing validation and QA efforts for a complex, multi-product, Datacenter, enterprise network performance platform in an Agile environment. Defined test strategies, plans, and coverage across integrated applications, managed and mentored global QA teams, and coordinated schedules and delivery with product management, engineering, marketing, and sales engineering. Drove integration, regression, and user acceptance testing, incorporated customer feedback through beta and on-site testing programs, and ensured release readiness through data-driven reviews and continuous process improvement.

EDUCATION

MASTER'S DEGREE | MS in Technology Commercialization | The University of Texas at Austin

2011– 2012

BACHELOR'S DEGREE | Lower Division BS in Computer Science | The University of Texas at Austin

1998 – 2000

BACHELOR'S DEGREE | BA in Music Education and Performance | The University of Texas at Austin

1992 – 1997